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1) Yin/Yang Dun Boundary Rule

Rule (verbatim): “冬至一阳生，夏至一阴生” (At the Winter Solstice, one Yang is born; at the Summer Solstice, one Yin is born.)[1]. In other words, **from Winter Solstice up to (but not including) Summer Solstice, use Yang Dun; from Summer Solstice up to (but not including) the next Winter Solstice, use Yin Dun**[1][2].

Decision logic (short): Determine the current 24-Term node (节气). If it falls in the half-year from Winter Solstice through mid-year, select a Yang Dun chart; if it falls in the half-year from Summer Solstice through year-end, select a Yin Dun chart[1][2]. This follows the classical maxim that “*at Winter Solstice, yang energy begins to grow; at Summer Solstice, yin energy begins to grow*.”

Source quote: “关于阴遁局和阳遁局…**冬至一阳生，夏至一阴生**，就是冬至到夏至前这段时间全部起阳遁局，夏至到冬至前这段全部起阴遁局。[1]” (Translation: “Regarding Yin Dun and Yang Dun: *‘At Winter Solstice one Yang is born, at Summer Solstice one Yin is born,’* meaning from Winter Solstice up to before Summer Solstice all charts use Yang Dun, and from Summer Solstice up to before Winter Solstice all use Yin Dun.”)

URL: [1]

2) Yuan (上元/中元/下元) Determination

Rule (verbatim): “甲己为符头，四仲—子、午、卯、酉为上元，四孟—寅、申、巳、亥为中元，四季—辰、戌、丑、未为下元[3].” This means **use days with Stem Jia or Ji as the start (Fu Tou) of each Yuan; if that Fu Tou day’s Earthly Branch is Zi, Wu, Mao, or You (the four “仲” branches), it marks the Upper Yuan; if it is Yin, Shen, Si, or Hai (four “孟” branches), it marks the Middle Yuan; if it is Chen, Xu, Chou, or Wei (four “季” branches), it marks the Lower Yuan**[3][4].

Decision logic (short): For a given date, find the nearest previous day whose Heavenly Stem is **Jia (甲)** or **Ji (己)** – this day is the **Fu Tou (符头)** start of a 5-day cycle (one “Yuan”). Determine that Fu Tou day’s Earthly Branch: if it belongs to **Zi/ Wu/ Mao/ You**, then the current date lies in the **Upper Yuan**; if **Yin/ Shen/ Si/ Hai**, then **Middle Yuan**; if **Chen/ Xu/ Chou/ Wei**, then **Lower Yuan**[3][5]. (Each 15-day solar term is thus divided into three 5-day Yuan periods: upper, middle, lower.)

Source quote: “…按照奇门遁甲中**甲己为符头**…遇**子午卯酉为上元，寅申巳亥为中元，辰戌丑未为下元**…[6]” (Translation: “…according to Qi Men Dun Jia, **take Jia or Ji as the Fu Tou**. When encountering **Zi, Wu, Mao, or You it is Upper Yuan**; **Yin, Shen, Si, or Hai is Middle Yuan**; **Chen, Xu, Chou, or Wei is Lower Yuan**…”)

URL: [6]

3) Zhi Run Intercalary Rule (置润 / 接气 / 超神)
Exact rule set (step-by-step, numbered):

1. **Determine "Fu Tou" vs Solar Term:** For each new **solar term** period, identify the first day of the Upper Yuan (the Fu Tou day). If this Fu Tou day **arrives before** the actual solar term's start time, it's called **"Chāo Shén" 超神** (Transcending Spirit) – the cyclical start **leads** the term. If the Fu Tou day **falls after** the term has begun (i.e. the term starts but the appropriate Jia/Ji day hasn't occurred yet), it's called **"Jiē Qì" 接气** (Connecting Qi) – the cycle **lags** behind the term. If the Fu Tou coincides exactly with the term start day, it's a **"Zhèng Shòu" 正授** (Direct Alignment)[7][8].
2. **Chart assignment in Chāo Shén or Jiē Qì:** In a **Chāo Shén** scenario, the new Dun's chart is taken to start early (before the nominal Jieqi); in a **Jiē Qì** scenario, the previous term's last Yuan extends until the Fu Tou day arrives. In practice, one continues using the prior chart until the Fu Tou day of the new term occurs[8][9]. (For example, if a new term begins at 11:13 AM, any query at 11:10 AM still uses the previous term's chart, switching over precisely at 11:13[10].)
3. **Intercalation (置润) trigger:** Over the year, repeated Chāo Shén leads the Fu Tou day drifting earlier each term. **When the Fu Tou leads the solar term by 9 or more days, an intercalary adjustment ("Zhi Run") is made**[9]. This occurs **only at two specific terms**: **Mángzhòng (芒种)** and **Dàxuě (大雪)**, the last terms before the Yang→Yin and Yin→Yang transitions (summer and winter solstices). At those terms, the entire Upper/Middle/Lower Yuan sequence is repeated (an "intercalary Ju") to realign the cycle with the next solstice[9].
4. **Intercalation implementation:** During intercalation, the outgoing term's Lower Yuan is immediately followed by an extra set of Upper/Middle/Lower cycles (using the same Dun and Ju numbers again) before proceeding to the next term's chart[9]. For example, "置润于芒种节" means after normal Mangzhong Lower Yuan (which might be Yang Dun 9局), one inserts another Mangzhong Upper/Middle/Lower (repeating 阳遁6、3、9局) before starting the Xiàzhì (Summer Solstice) Yin Dun charts[9].
5. **Edge-case handling:** Intercalation is **not applied at any other solar terms** even if the lead exceeds nine days[11]. Likewise, if Fu Tou lags behind (Jiē Qì) significantly, no "negative" intercalation is done; the misalignment is resolved naturally at the next solstice transition when a Zhi Run (if needed) adjusts the schedule. The **solar term boundary moment** (交节时刻) is strictly observed – charts change at the exact calculated time of the Jieqi. If a query spans a term

transition, determine which side of the boundary the time falls on, and use the appropriate chart accordingly[12].

Edge-case: In rare cases where a solar term's actual length isn't exactly 15 days (due to astronomical variation), the above Fu Tou method inherently accounts for it by using the Jia/Ji day cycle. The insertion of a "Leap Ju" (润局) ensures the calendar's 1080 hourly charts align correctly with the 24 Jieqi each year[9].

Source quote(s):

- *"节气上元的头一天跑到节气的前边…这叫'超神'。节气上元的头一天落到节气的后边…这叫'接气'。符头与节气同至，这叫'正授'。"*[7] (Defines **Chao Shen, Jie Qi, Zheng Shou** as above.)
- *"超至九日及十余日，则当置闰…置闰必在芒种、大雪之后，二至之前…阳遁从冬至开始，阴遁从夏至开始，在二至之前的节气置闰，就是在阳遁阴遁开始之前把符头调好…。"*[13] (Intercalation occurs once Fu Tou leads by ~10 days, specifically after Mangzhong or Daxue, to realign before the solstice; this ensures the cycle resets so the Dun change at the solstice isn't off by too many days.)
- *"例如…交清明节，那么此日11时10分仍属春分局内…到11时13分则过了清明节，就是清明的局元了…"*[12] (Example of chart switching exactly at the Jieqi time on April 5, with Spring Equinox chart used until 11:12, then Qingming chart from 11:13 onward.)
  URL(s): [14][13]

4) Yin-Dun & Yang-Dun Ju Tables

Below is the complete mapping of Ju (局) numbers for Yang Dun and Yin Dun charts, indexed by solar term (节气) and Yuan. Each row shows one **solar term or term-pair** ("JieQi group") and the Ju numbers used for its Upper, Middle, and Lower Yuan. (Yang-period terms are marked **(Yang)**; Yin-period terms marked **(Yin)**.)

JieQi Group	Upper Yuan Ju	Middle Yuan Ju	Lower Yuan Ju	Source
Winter Solstice **冬至** / Jingzhe 惊蛰 (Yang)	1 (Yang 1局)	7 (Yang 7局)	4 (Yang 4局)	[15][16]

JieQi Group	Upper Yuan Ju	Middle Yuan Ju	Lower Yuan Ju	Source
Minor Cold 小寒 (Yang)	2	8	5	[15]
Major Cold 大寒 / Spring Equinox 春分 (Yang)	3	9	6	[15]
Rain Water 雨水 (Yang)	9	6	3	[15]
Clear Bright 清明 / Start of Summer 立夏 (Yang)	4	1	7	[15]
Start of Spring 立春 (Yang)	8	5	2	[15]
Grain Rain 谷雨 / Grain Full 小满 (Yang)	5	2	8	[15]
Grain in Ear 芒种 (Yang)	6	3	9	[15]
Summer Solstice 夏至 / White Dew 白露 (Yin)	9 (Yin 9局)	3 (Yin 3局)	6 (Yin 6局)	[17][18]
Minor Heat 小暑 (Yin)	8	2	5	[17]

JieQi Group	Upper Yuan Ju	Middle Yuan Ju	Lower Yuan Ju	Source
Major Heat 大暑 / Autumn Equinox 秋分 (Yin)	7	1	4	[17]
Start of Autumn 立秋 (Yin)	2	5	8	[17]
End of Heat 处暑 (Yin)	1	4	7	[17]
Cold Dew 寒露 / Start of Winter 立冬 (Yin)	6	9	3	[17]
Frost Descent 霜降 / Minor Snow 小雪 (Yin)	5	8	2	[17]
Major Snow 大雪 (Yin)	4	7	1	[19]

Source quote(s):

- *"阳遁九局：冬至惊蛰一七四，小寒二八五…清明立夏四一七，芒种六三九为宜。[15]" – (Yang Dun example: Winter Solstice or Jingzhe Upper=1, Middle=7, Lower=4; Minor Cold 2/8/5; … Qingming or Lixia 4/1/7; Mangzhong 6/3/9.)*
- *"阴遁九局：夏至白露九三六，小暑八二五…立冬寒露六九三…[17]" – (Yin Dun example: Summer Solstice or White Dew 9/3/6; Minor Heat 8/2/5; … Start of Winter or Cold Dew 6/9/3, etc.)*
  (These verses enumerate the Upper/Middle/Lower Ju numbers for each term. For instance, "冬至惊蛰一七四" means Winter Solstice or Jingzhe Upper Yuan

uses Ju 1, Middle 7, Lower 4[16].)
URL(s): [15][20]

5) Fu Tou (符头) / Xun Shou (旬首) Determination
Rule (verbatim): "每局头一天的日干就必须是甲或己[21]." – **The first day of each 5-day Ju must have a Heavenly Stem Jia (甲) or Ji (己)**[21]. These Jia/Ji starting days are called **Fu Tou** ("talisman head") and correspond to the **Xun Shou** (旬首, 10-day cycle head) in the sexagenary cycle. The classical mnemonic is "**以甲己为符头**"[4]. Practically, **Jia and Ji days mark the boundaries between Yuan periods**.
Decision logic (short): To determine the chart for a given date/time, **identify the current 5-day block's Fu Tou day**. Count backward (or forward) to find the nearest date whose Heavenly Stem is **Jia** or **Ji** – that date is the Fu Tou start of the current Yuan[22]. Once found, use the Earthly Branch of that Fu Tou day to determine Upper/Middle/Lower Yuan as per Rule 2 above. For example, if the current date is a **Ren Xu day (壬戌)**, one counts backward day by day through the stems until reaching **Ji**; suppose the nearest Ji-day is **Ji Wei (己未)** – that is the Fu Tou. Since Wei is one of the four "seasonal" branches, the chart is in the **Lower Yuan**[23].
Source quote: *"每个节气上中下三元头一天的干支规律是：每个节气上元头一天的干支不是甲子或甲午，就是己卯或己酉；中元头一天的干支不是甲申或甲寅，就是己巳或己亥；下元头一天的干支不是甲戌或甲辰，就是己丑或己未。"*[22] *(This enumerates all possible Fu Tou day stem-branch combinations: Upper Yuan must start on either Jia-Zi, Jia-Wu, Ji-Mao or Ji-You; Middle on Jia-Shen, Jia-Yin, Ji-Si or Ji-Hai; Lower on Jia-Xu, Jia-Chen, Ji-Chou or Ji-Wei.)*
URL: [22]

6) Sequence Orders
(Canonical sequences of the fundamental elements in QMDJ, with Chinese names and brief English labels).

- **Three Qi / Six Yi order (三奇六仪):** The nine active Heavenly Stems (excluding hidden **Jia**). In QMDJ these are ordered as **戊→己→庚→辛→壬→癸→丁→丙→乙**, which comprises the **Six "Yi" (仪)**: Wu, Ji, Geng, Xin, Ren, Gui (the six common stems), followed by the **Three "Qi" (奇)**: Ding, Bing, Yi (the three auspicious stems)[24]. *This is the fixed Earth-plate stem order:* e.g. in Yang Dun Ju 1, they occupy Lo Shu palaces 1–9 in this sequence[25]. (Jia is absent – "hidden" – in the chart[26].)
- **Nine Stars order (九星):** The nine celestial stars used in Qimen, traditionally named: **天蓬, 天任, 天冲, 天辅, 天英, 天芮, 天柱, 天心, 天禽**[27]. In English they

are often rendered as **Tian Peng**, **Tian Ren**, **Tian Chong**, **Tian Fu**, **Tian Ying**, **Tian Rui**, **Tian Zhu**, **Tian Xin**, **Tian Qin** – representing various cosmic energies. These stars have a fixed Lo Shu assignment: e.g. Tian Peng resides in Kan (1), Tian Ren in Gen (8), … Tian Xin in Qian (6), Tian Qin in center (5)[28]. The usual listing follows the Later Heaven Bagua order (north to center): *Tian Peng → Tian Ren → Tian Chong → Tian Fu → Tian Ying → Tian Rui → Tian Zhu → Tian Xin → Tian Qin*[29]. (Among these, **Tian Peng, Tian Rui, Tian Zhu** are considered inauspicious stars; **Tian Xin, Tian Ren, Tian Fu** are auspicious, and **Tian Qin, Tian Ying, Tian Chong** neutral[27].)

- **Eight Doors order (八门):** The eight portals are **休门, 生门, 伤门, 杜门, 景门, 死门, 惊门, 开门** – known in English as the **Rest, Life, Injury (Harm), Delusion (Obstacle), Scenery (View), Death, Alarm (Fear), and Open** doors, respectively[30][31]. A common mnemonic arrangement is "**休生伤杜，景死惊开**," which maps each door to a Lo Shu palace (e.g. Kan 1: Rest, Gen 8: Life, Zhen 3: Injury, Xun 4: Delusion, Li 9: Scenery, Kun 2: Death, Dui 7: Alarm, Qian 6: Open)[32]. These doors cycle through the palaces as the chart changes, influencing outcome tendencies (three are generally auspicious – Open, Rest, Life; three are inauspicious – Death, Alarm, Injury; and two neutral – Delusion, Scenery[33]).
- **Eight Spirits (Gods) order (八神):** The eight deities commonly used are **值符, 螣蛇, 太阴, 六合, 白虎, 玄武, 九地, 九天**[34] – namely **Chief (Zhi Fu)**, **Flying Serpent**, **Great Yin**, **Six Harmony**, **White Tiger**, **Black Tortoise**, **Nine Earth**, **Nine Heaven**. They are arranged in a fixed sequence around the palaces. Typically, the **Chief Deity (Value Marker)** occupies the palace of the day/hour's stem (as leader), and the rest follow in the order above. For a **Yang Dun** chart, the gods are assigned **forward (clockwise)**; for a **Yin Dun** chart, they are assigned **in reverse (counter-clockwise)** around the lo shu sequence[35]. (In some texts, alternative names like **Gou Chen** for White Tiger and **Zhu Que** for Black Tortoise appear – see Variant rules in section 9.)

Source quote + URL for each:

- "六仪：戊、己、庚、辛、壬、癸为六仪。"[36] (Defines the six Yi stems; the remaining three of the ten are the San Qi).
- "九星就是天蓬、天任、天冲、天辅、天英、天芮、天柱、天心、天禽九颗星。"[29] (Lists the nine stars by name).
- "八门包括休、生、伤、杜、景、死、惊、开，遵循特定顺序，并在八卦宫位中循环排列。"[37] ("Eight Doors comprise Xiu, Sheng, Shang, Du, Jing, Si, Jing, Kai, following a set order and cycling through the trigram palaces.")

- *“八神即值符、腾蛇、太阴、六合、白虎、玄武、九地、九天。”*[38] (Lists the eight spirits as above).

7) Rotating Palace Placement Rules
Qi Men Dun Jia charts are constructed on a 3×3 Lo Shu grid (Nine Palaces). **Setting up a chart (排盘)** involves placing the Earth Plate (stems), Heaven Plate (stars), Human Plate (doors), and Spirit Plate (gods) in their appropriate palaces, following Yin or Yang Dun rules for rotation. Key rules include:

- **Earth plate stems (三奇六仪布宫):** For **Yang Dun**, *“顺布六仪，逆布三奇”*[25] – place the six Yi stems in forward order and the three Qi in reverse order around the palaces. Specifically, the Ju’s starting palace is determined by the Ju number (1–9 corresponds to Lo Shu palace 1–9). From that start palace, assign **Wu→Ji→Geng→Xin→Ren→Gui** sequentially into palaces (clockwise), then place **Ding→Bing→Yi** into the remaining palaces in the opposite direction[25][39]. (In Ju 1 Yang Dun, for example, **Wu** goes to palace 1坎, … **Gui** to palace 6乾, then **Ding** to palace 7兑, **Bing** to 8艮, **Yi** to 9离[40].) For **Yin Dun**, the rule inverts: *“逆布六仪，顺布三奇”* – place the six Yi in reverse (counter-clockwise) order and the three Qi in forward order[39]. *(Thus, Yin Dun Ju 1 would start Gui at Li 9 and go backwards.)* These rules ensure **Jia (甲)** – considered the “hidden stem” – is not placed on the board (it is concealed under the Earth plate and never appears in a palace[26]).
- **Heaven plate stars:** The nine stars have fixed “home” palaces in the Luo Shu (e.g. Tian Peng at 1坎, … Tian Xin at 6乾, Tian Qin usually “lodged” in 5 center but effectively placed in a certain palace)[28]. To deploy them for the current chart, **identify the star tied to the day’s Stem (the “Value Symbol” star, 值符星)** and **place it in the palace of the current hour’s heavenly stem** on the Earth plate[24]. The remaining stars are then distributed to the other palaces in numeric order (for Yang Dun charts usually clockwise increasing, for Yin possibly counterclockwise – though some lineages keep star order always forward)[28]. This rotation means the Heaven plate “floats” over the Earth plate each hour. *(Example: if the hour’s Earthly Stem palace should host the chief star Tian Peng, put Tian Peng there, then next stars in sequence in subsequent palaces.)* In practice, after placing the stars, the **Zhi Fu (chief spirit)** will reside in the palace where **Tian Peng** star is (for Yang Dun initial chart) or where appropriate based on the rotating cycle[28][41].
- **Eight Doors (Human plate):** The eight doors likewise rotate each time unit. Typically, one determines the **Zhi Shi door (值使门)** – the door that is “on duty”

for the current chart (often associated with the hour's earthly branch or the position of the chief star)[24]. **Place that door in the palace of the hour's branch**, then arrange the other doors in their standard order around the board. In a **Yang Dun** hour, doors are usually advanced **forward (clockwise)** from their previous positions; in **Yin Dun**, they advance **backward**[35][24]. (This aligns with the rule "时盘顺转时为阳，逆转时为阴" – if the hour plates rotate forward, it's a Yang chart; if they rotate backward, it's a Yin chart[42].) For example, if in one chart the Rest Door (休门) was in palace 1 and it's a Yang Dun, the next chart will move it to palace 2; if it's a Yin Dun, Rest Door would move to palace 9 instead. The doors thus cycle through palaces in a repeating pattern as time progresses.

- **Eight Spirits (Spirit plate):** The eight gods are anchored by the **Chief Deity (值符)**, which always starts in the palace holding the **day's Stem Jia** (or in many methods, the palace of the hourly Zhi Fu star)[43]. After fixing the Chief, the remaining seven spirits are placed in a fixed sequence. **For Yang Dun charts, the gods are assigned in descending palace order (around the grid clockwise)**; **for Yin Dun, assign them in ascending order (counter-clockwise)**[35]. In other words, in Yang Dun the sequence **Zhi Fu → Teng She → Tai Yin → Liu He → Bai Hu → Xuan Wu → Jiu Di → Jiu Tian** is placed going forward through palace numbers, whereas in Yin Dun the same sequence is placed going in reverse numerical order[35]. This yields the so-called "forward rotating" vs "reverse rotating" spirit plate, matching the Dun type. *(Some sources alternatively swap White Tiger/Black Tortoise in Yin charts with Gou Chen/ Zhu Que in Yang – see section 9.)* The net effect: **Yang Dun** charts have the auxiliary plates (doors, gods) moving **shùn (with the natural order)**, while **Yin Dun** charts move **nì (against the order)**[35].

Source quote(s):

- *"阳遁九局，顺布六仪逆布三奇…二局则甲子戊起坤二宫，三局…馀仿此。阴遁九局，逆布六仪顺布三奇…"*[40] (Yang Dun: place six Yi forward, three Qi reverse; Yin Dun opposite.)
- *"八门…在人盘里随天盘时干宫转…阳顺阴逆…。"*[35][24] (Eight Doors and Eight Gods follow the rotation of the Heaven plate: *"the arrangement is yang-clockwise, yin-counterclockwise."*)
- *"值符每逐时乾转，值使常随天乙奔。"*[44] ("The chief star/god rotates to Qian palace each hour, the duty door follows the celestial Yi (Jia) swiftly" – poetic description of chief deity and door movement aligning with time.)

URL(s): [40][35]

8) Day-School vs Hour-School Differences

Qi Men Dun Jia can be applied at different time scales. **"Hour-School" Qimen (时家奇门)** – the most common – computes a new chart every 2-hour **shi chen**, yielding 1080 unique charts per year[45]. **"Day-School" Qimen (日家奇门)** uses one chart per day (120 unique charts in a year)[46]. They share the same fundamentals (nine palaces, yin/yang dun, eight doors, etc.[47]) but have notable differences[48]:

- **Chart count & cycle:** Hour Qimen has 1080 charts (Yang & Yin nine Ju cycles repeating every 5 days, aligned to 24 terms)[45]. Day Qimen has only 120 charts for the year (typically 60 Yang Ju for the first half-year, 60 Yin Ju for the second, aligned to days)[49]. Day Qimen's cycle resets each year, whereas Hour Qimen completes a full 4320-hour cycle each year (with repeats)[45].
- **Ju arrangement method:** The method to determine the Ju number is different. Hour Qimen follows the complex 24-term, 72-Yuan system described above. Day Qimen uses a simpler rule: it often divides days by the 12 Jian/Shen (建/守) days or solar months. For instance, Day Qimen might fix the **Rest Door** on the day's branch and rotate it every 3 days, and apply Yang or Yin Dun based on Winter/Summer solstice and the day's stem parity[42]. In short, Day Qimen charts change more coarsely (one Ju can last several days)[42].
- **Nine Stars set:** The two systems employ different star sets. Hour Qimen uses the classical nine stars *Tian Peng, Tian Ren, … Tian Qin* as given above. **Day Qimen uses an alternate set of nine stars** (often borrowed from the **Taiyi system**): e.g. **太乙, 摄提, 轩辕, 招摇, 天符, 青龙, 咸池, 太阴, 天乙**[50]. These correspond to another cosmological model and have different meanings. Thus, the star in the center of a Day Qimen chart is *Taiyi* rather than *Tian Qin*, etc. Hour Qimen does not use the Taiyi star set[50].
- **Structures & auguries:** Hour Qimen recognizes many specific auspicious/inauspicious formations (格) based on the interaction of stars/doors/gods (e.g. Flying Bird Falling Nest, Dragons Turning Gate, etc.). **Day Qimen omits dozens of these special formations** – it is generally less granular in interpretive nuance[51][48]. Instead, Day Qimen incorporates traditional daily astrology elements: for example, it observes the **12 Day Officer (黑黄道)** classification for each day and the auspicious deity directions like **Happy God (喜神)**, which Hour Qimen typically does not use[48].
- **Precision vs. simplicity:** Hour Qimen is considered more precise ("**时家奇门**比较实用，按具体时间来布局" – it charts the exact hour for fine-grained divination)[52]. Day Qimen is broader ("**日家奇门**以日为主…预测判断也很准确，但精确到时

辰又略显不足” – it uses the day as unit; accurate for daily trends, but not as detailed to the hour)[52]. In exchange, Day Qimen is simpler to calculate and was historically used when hour data or rapid calculation was inconvenient[49].

In summary, Hour-School Qimen is the mainstream method for divination and event timing in modern practice (due to its higher resolution and the fact that “year better < month < day < hour” for auspice)[53]. Day-School Qimen survives in some traditions (and was noted to have a total of 120局, versus 1080局 for hour Qimen)[46], but it lacks some of the fine detail and special structures of Hour Qimen. Both share the same fundamental yin/yang dun switching at solstices and the same eight doors, etc., so a Day Qimen chart can be seen as a “frozen” Qimen chart for the entire day[47].

Source quote(s):

- *“日家奇门与时家奇门的4个相同点：一是都以九宫八卦为排盘…二是都分阴遁和阳遁…三是都用八门…四是都忌五不遇时。日家奇门与时家奇门的5个不同点：一是排局方法不同；二是九星不同；三是日家奇门没有时家奇门的几十个吉凶格；四是日家奇门分十二黑黄道，时家奇门不分；五是日家奇门论喜神方位，时家奇门则没有。”*[54] (Lists the 4 similarities and 5 differences between Day and Hour Qimen as summarized above.)
- *“‘日家奇门’以日为主来布局…‘时家奇门’比较实用，按具体时间来布局。”*[52] (“Day Qimen uses the day as the basis for the layout… Hour Qimen is more practical, laying out according to the exact hour.”)
  URL(s): [48][52]

9) Conflicts / Variants
Because Qi Men Dun Jia was transmitted through various schools (San Yuan vs San He, “Flying Palace” vs “Rotating Palace” methods, etc.), historical texts and modern practitioners present **variant rules**. Notable conflicts and variations include:

- **Eight Gods Set (Yang vs Yin):**
- *Rule A:* Most sources use a fixed set of **Eight Deities** for all charts: **Chief (值符)**, **Teng She**, **Tai Yin**, **Liu He**, **White Tiger (白虎)**, **Black Tortoise (玄武)**, **Nine Earth**, **Nine Heaven**[55]. These correspond to the classical Eight Gods (sometimes called Eight Generals) and remain the same in Yin or Yang Dun.
- *Rule B:* Some lineages (often associated with **San He/”Flying” Qimen**) swap two gods in Yang vs. Yin. In Yang Dun, the deity **Gou Chen (勾陈)** is used in place of White Tiger, and **Zhu Que (朱雀)** in place of Black Tortoise; in Yin Dun, White Tiger and Black Tortoise are used (Gou Chen and Zhu Que effectively

"hide" under them)[56][57]. In other words, the Yang chart's spirit sequence might be "Chief, Teng She, Tai Yin, Liu He, **Gou Chen**, **Zhu Que**, Jiu Di, Jiu Tian," whereas the Yin chart's sequence is "Chief… **White Tiger**, **Black Tortoise**, Jiu Di, Jiu Tian." This approach aligns with certain military Qimen traditions that include the **Five Heavenly Animals** (青龙 Azure Dragon appears as Chief or as a hidden ninth spirit in some versions)[58].

- *Notes:* The "Rule A" set is commonly used in modern **Zhuan Pan (rotating) Qimen**, while "Rule B" appears in older texts like the *Qimen TONG Zong* and is sometimes called the **"Nine Gods"** approach (counting the interchangeable gods)[59][56]. Both methods yield functionally eight positions on the spirit plate, but the labels differ.

- **Heaven Center Star (Tian Qin) Placement:**

- *Rule A:* Many sources place the **Tian Qin (Heavenly Bird)** star (the nominal center, Lo Shu 5 star) in the **Kun (SW, palace 2)** for chart calculation in both Yin and Yang Dun. This is implied by saying "天禽星寄坤宫" – Tian Qin is lodged in Kun palace (since the center palace is not used)[28]. Thus the Lo Shu 5 is effectively mapped to Kun for both Dun types in those systems.
- *Rule B:* Some texts specify a different lodging in Yin vs Yang: e.g. "天禽阳遁寄坤宫，阴遁寄艮宫"[28] – meaning **in Yang Dun charts, Tian Qin sits in Kun 2-palace, but in Yin Dun charts, Tian Qin is placed in Gen 8-palace**. This variant ensures the central star's polarity aligns with the Dun (since Kun is an Earth/Yin palace and Gen is Earth/Yang in Later Heaven Bagua).
- *Notes:* The *Qimen Dun Jia Mi Ji* (秘笈大全) attributes *Rule A* as the standard, mentioning *Rule B* as coming from "one version" (一本) of transmission[28]. Modern Qimen software typically follows Rule A (Tian Qin always in Kun), whereas some traditionalists follow Rule B for Yin Dun adjustments. The difference slightly alters which star is considered "center" in Yin charts (Tian Qin vs an alternate star).

- **Flying Palace vs Rotating Palace (Fei Gong vs Zhuan Pan):**

- *Rule A (Zhuan Pan 排宫法):* The mainstream method (used above) is **Rotating Palace Qimen**, where the Earth plate is static and the Heaven, Door, and Spirit plates rotate through the 8 directions. The center palace is not actively used (Lo Shu 5 is assigned into another palace as noted), and we always have exactly eight doors and eight gods in play[60][56]. This is the system taught by most modern Qimen schools.

- *Rule B (Fei Gong 飞宫法):* A less common variant, **Flying Palace Qimen**, treats the center as a valid position and in some interpretations uses **9 gates** and **9 gods**. For example, one description of Fei Gong's door order is "休、生、伤、杜、中(空)、开、惊、生、景," effectively inserting a "null" door in the center and producing a different cycling order[61]. Similarly, some Fei Gong methods consider a **"Ninth God" (玄武+朱雀 combined or 青龙)** to account for the center. These differences lead to slightly altered charts and were used in certain lineages.
- *Notes:* Fei Gong vs Zhuan Pan has been a subject of debate – practitioners say "奇门无真" ("There is no single Truth in Qimen")[62], acknowledging multiple valid methods. In general, **Zhuan Pan (Rotating)** Qimen is far more widely used today[53][63], and Fei Pan/Flying Palace methods are esoteric. Some authors (like in *Smoke Wave Fisherman's Song* 烟波钓叟赋) present hybrid approaches – e.g. using Zhuan Pan for eight-god arrangement even when describing a Fei Pan chart[58]. It's important to stick to one method consistently.

- **Lineage differences in setting reference time:** Another practical variant: some masters set the chart for the **moment a question is asked**, while others use the moment of chart-casting. This is a methodological choice – e.g. one might cast for 9 AM when the client actually inquired, even if the chart is generated at 9 PM[64]. Both approaches are used ("奇门无真" again), so modern practice may vary on this point. The key is consistency within a given lineage or application.

Variant sources:
- "八神就是直符、螣蛇、太阴、六合、勾陈*(*阴遁为白虎*)*、朱雀*(*阴遁为玄武*)*、九地、九天。"[56] (Eight gods with Gou Chen/Zhu Que in Yang, White Tiger/Black Tortoise in Yin – a variant rule).
- "天禽阳遁阴遁俱寄坤宫，一本阳遁寄坤宫阴遁寄艮宫。"[28] (Standard says Tian Qin star stays in Kun for both; one version says Kun for Yang, Gen for Yin).
- "飞盘奇门…这里比转盘奇门多了一个中五宫…八门排列顺序是休门、死门、伤门、杜门、中五、开门、惊门、生门、景门。"[65] (Describing a Flying Palace layout including the center as an extra "gate", versus the Rotating method with 8 doors).
- "奇门自发展以来，就有很大争议，叫'奇门无真'…"[62] ("Since Qimen's development there has been great controversy, known as 'Qimen has no single truth'." – acknowledging the coexistence of different methods).
- "现在用的最多的还是转盘…飞盘尚有一盘九神之说。"[66] ("Nowadays the most used is the rotating plate… The flying plate even has a saying of a nine-god layout.") This

highlights the divergence, with rotating method dominating current practice and the flying method having a different god setup.

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